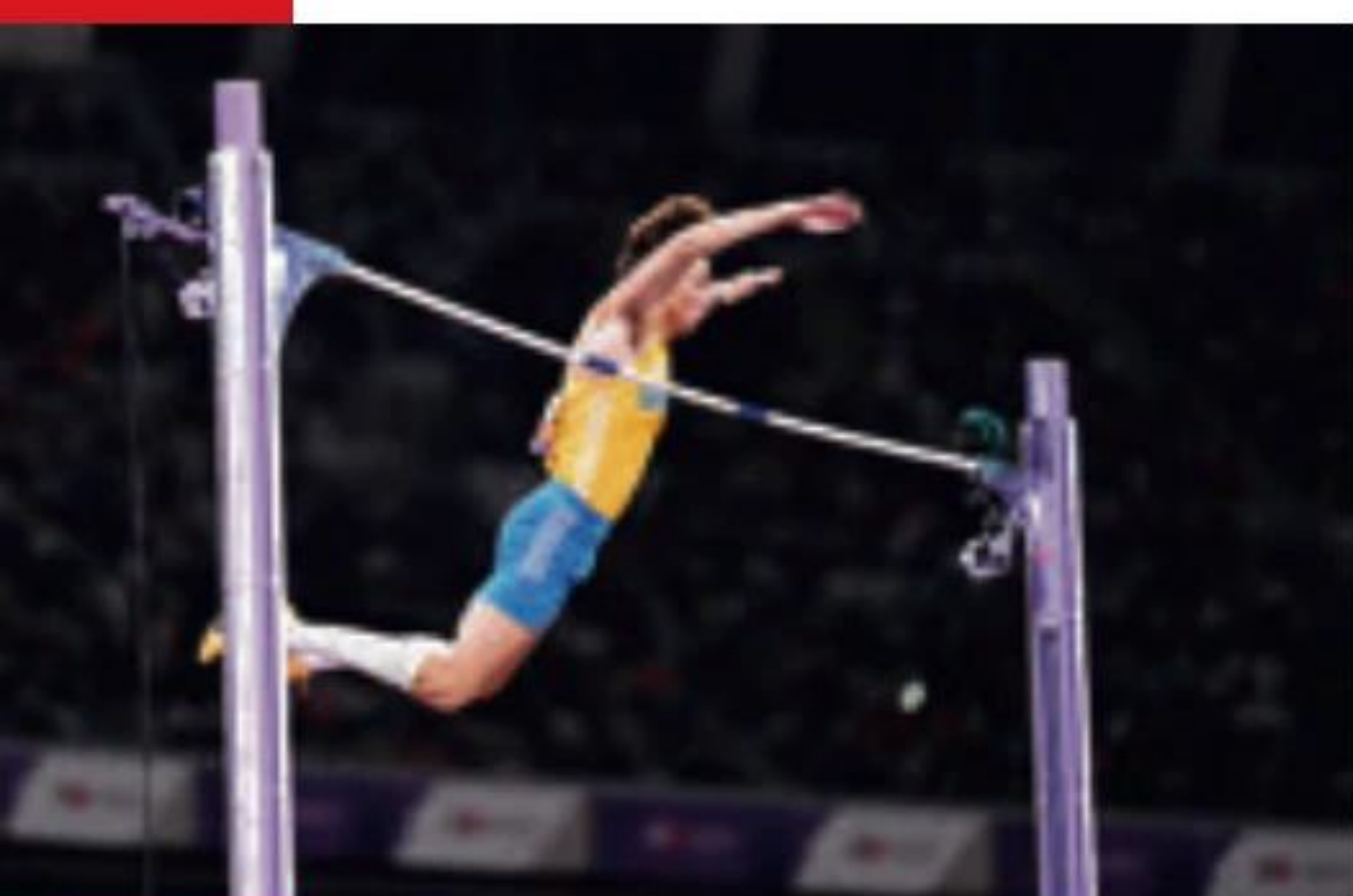




2

Italy became only the second nation ever to simultaneously hold the men's and women's World Volleyball Championship titles after winning both crowns in September. While the Italian women claimed the title in Bangkok, their male counterparts defended their championship in Manila. The Soviet Union achieved the double twice — in 1956 and 1960.



6.30

Armand Duplantis broke his own pole vault world record for the 14th time, clearing 6.30m at the World Athletics Championships 2025 in Tokyo. With another \$100,000 in the bag for the Swede, World Athletics president Sebastian Coe joked that the body might have to give up its Christmas party if he breaks the record again.



7

Bengaluru Bulls' Shubham Bitake broke Pardeep Narwal's record for most raid points in a single raid during a Pro Kabaddi League match against Patna Pirates. Pardeep had earlier bagged six raid points plus two more for effecting an all-out for the Pirates against Haryana Steelers, which remains the most points earned by a team in a single raid.

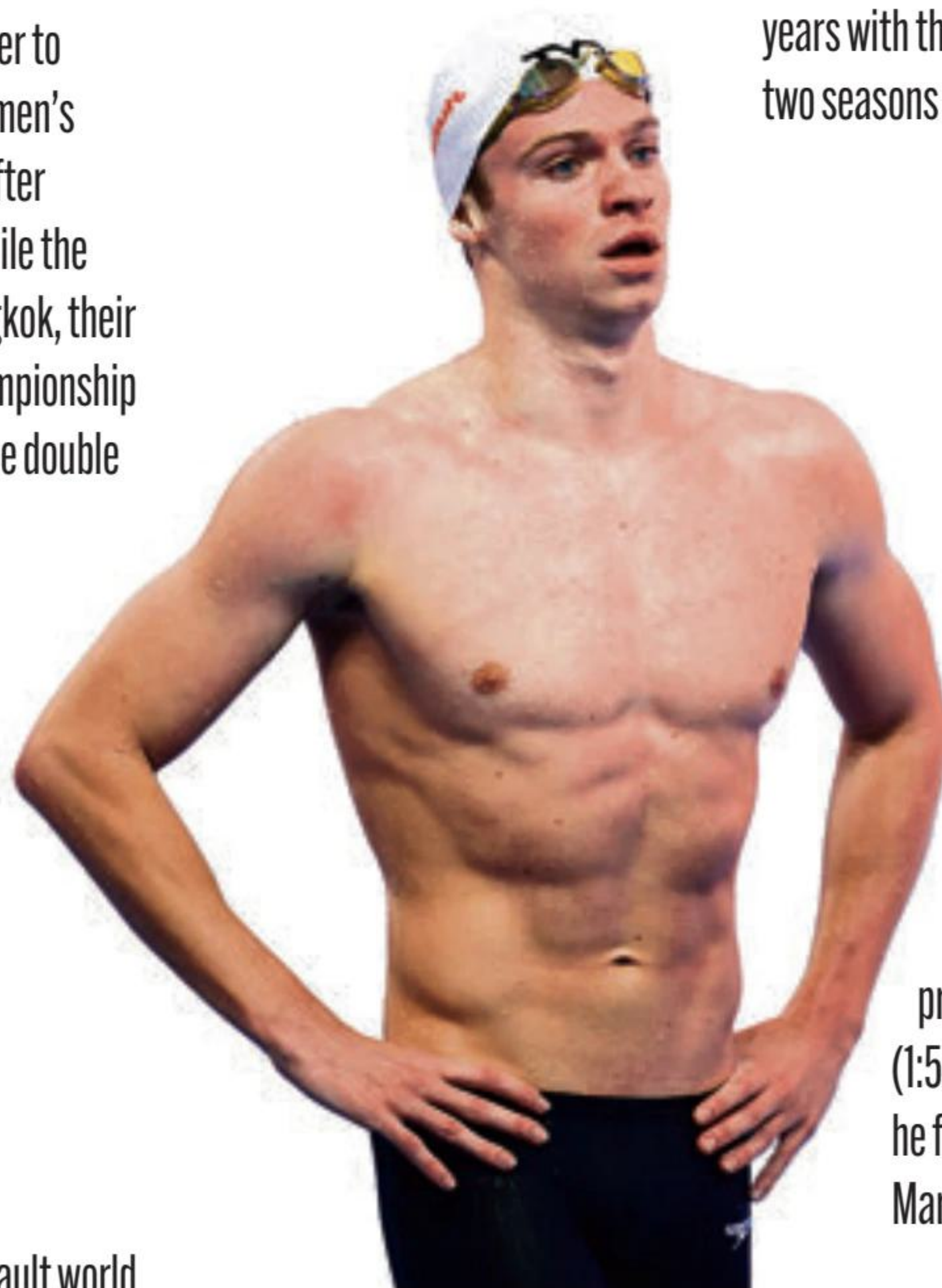
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4

Japanese baseball player Shohei Ohtani won his fourth Major League Baseball MVP

award. Only Barry Bonds, with seven, has won more MVP titles than the Los Angeles Dodgers star. After two MVPs in five years with the Los Angeles Angels, Ohtani has added two in two seasons with the Dodgers.



1.31

French swimmer Leon Marchand set a new world record (1:52.69) in the 200m individual medley at the World Aquatics Championships in Singapore. He shattered the previous mark held by USA's Ryan Lochte (1:54.00) by 1.31 seconds in the semifinal. Though he failed to scale the same heights in the final, Marchand still secured gold in the event.



8

European powerhouse Germany extended its record for the

most men's Junior Hockey World Cup titles after defeating Spain in a shootout in the final of the 2025 edition held across Chennai and Madurai. India and Argentina are next best, with two titles each. Germany had also won the Indoor World Cup held in Croatia in February this year.